

# Wickets to **Wanderlust**

**Former cricketer Yuvraj Singh lets us in on the places that bring him peace, play and the perfect meal**

**Q. Your work takes you places. Which is one destination that you've given your heart to?**

Queenstown in New Zealand is hands down the most beautiful city I've ever seen. It feels like someone set it up for a movie. Every frame is cinematic, with the mountains, the lake and the stillness. There's a calm there, a quiet energy that stays with you long after you've left.

**Q. What's your take on travelling in the monsoon?**

Monsoon travel has a special charm. I would love to head to Coorg or experience the drive to Glenorchy in New Zealand in light rain. That route is already stunning and I can only imagine how magical it must look with the clouds rolling in. It's the kind of weather that makes you want to sit by a window, sip something warm, and just watch the world go by.

**Q. Your idea of an ideal getaway.**

Someplace where I can breathe easy—a quiet beach, a hillside town, or just a small city with character. Good weather, great food, a nice walk and no stress. That's ideal. And, of course, if there's a place that surprises me with food, that's a bonus.

**Q. Does this mean you enjoy experimenting with food on your travels?**

Absolutely. Some of my favourite memories come from small food joints or local street food stalls. From pan-Asian flavours in Singapore to coastal curries in India, I've picked up ideas everywhere. A lot of those experiences have found their way into my restaurant KOCA located in Gurugram. We took comfort food and gave it a global edge, while keeping the soul intact. Travel taught me that food isn't just about taste, it's about how it makes you feel.

**Q. A destination in India that you can always go back to.**

Goa, without a doubt. It's where I go to unwind. No pressure, no schedule. The food, the beaches and the relaxed pace—it just works for me. Whether I want a quiet break or some quality time with family and friends, Goa always delivers.

***–With Geetika Sachdev***